



The Evolution of Humor: Its Transformations and Psychological Impacts on Human Behavior

Marya Said and Leen Sawan

Abstract

This research paper explores humor as a psychological phenomenon and its role in human behavior. It delves into the evolutionary functions of humor, examining it through historical, cultural, and theoretical lenses, including Relief Theory, Incongruity Theory, and Superiority Theory. The study evaluates humor's societal role in easing people's lives by both a social and cognitive aspect. Key findings include the strong benefits of humor on mental health, promoting resilience in stressful situations, easing conflicts, enhancing creativity, and even accelerating physical healing. Other sub-topics of humor that are also addressed in this paper include: the threat of humorlessness, coping mechanisms in times of adversity, and social bonding. The study also contextualizes the potential risks and drawbacks of humor as a coping tool and explores how it can sometimes perpetuate harmful maladaptive humor styles (e.g., self-deprecating or aggressive humor). The research offers various advice on utilizing humor as well-being and social resources. This research connects humor to a broader context, including its role in mental health as a coping mechanism, with implications for social dynamics and psychological well-being. It also highlights its practical application in supporting therapy practices and educational tools in a complex world.

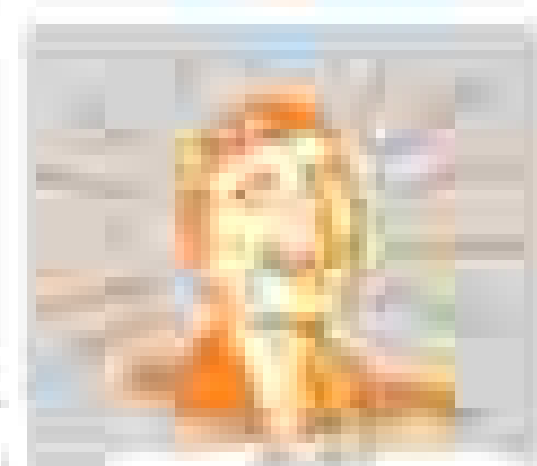
Keywords: Relief Theory, Incongruity Theory, Superiority Theory, Maladaptive Humor-Styles

Introduction

Humor has played a unique and evolving role in human, reflecting behavioral, social dynamics, and psychological well-being. From ancient times to the digital age, humor has transformed alongside cultural and technological shifts, serving as a vital tool for communication, emotional resilience, and social bonding. Humor can be used through historical, cultural, and psychological perspectives to gain insight into its powerful effects on both individual and collective behavior.

Recent years have highlighted humor's significance in mental health, with evidence showing its potential to reduce stress, foster coping, and enhance resilience. Therapeutic humor can be utilized as a helpful supplemental therapy in human stress in mental health as well as a therapy practice, intervention, and a self-help approach. In order to foster anxiety and sadness, therapeutic humor can psychologically distance the person from their own distressing and overwhelming experiences (Battaglini & Battaglini, 2011). Humor is now embedded in digital communication, affecting how people relate to one another and cope with life's challenges. The humor also helps in coping with racism. While it fosters connection and improves well-being, certain styles of humor can contribute to behaviors or attitudes that are negative (Petersen).

Humor is greater than what it seems. It has a bigger picture with deeper meaning behind it. It is an extremely complex topic, delving into the psychological aspects of human behavior which encompasses like how humor



efficiency (social skills, social resources, and coping strategies).

Schroyer 1. Types of humor:

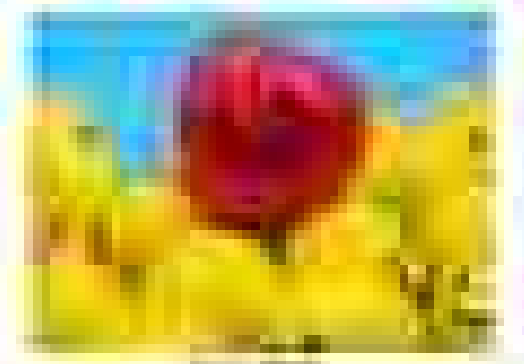
While most professionals have got accustomed, because people are doing to get the

Humor pattern of coping, including its style and purpose. The different kinds of humor, through wordplay, physical expressions, or stage humor, could have its own uses and impact (Hil, elaborating the different styles helps us appreciate how humor shapes culture, media, and day-to-day interactions.

Slapstick Comedy:

Slapstick comedy is a type of exaggerated physical humor that relies on physical, visual jokes, and over-the-top behavior to make the audience laugh.

It often involves characters getting into ridiculous situations, using props for comedic effect, or engaging in clumsy stunts and fights.



This style is a staple (and is) but very early, highly theatrical form of comedy. It has a history of being popular with the masses, such as Charlie Chaplin, Buster Keaton, and The Three Stooges. It has evolved but has some modern adaptations, and there are many modern slapstick comedies, though falling out of fashion and being replaced.

Modern examples of slapstick humor could be found in movies like *John & Amy* and *Looney Tunes*, or movies like *The Three Stooges* or *Charlie and the Chocolate Factory*. While some people consider slapstick to be simple or outdated, it is a form of comedy that has been around for centuries, using physical humor and verbal wit to entertain.

Aggressive Humor:

This is a type of humor that only a specific type of person would accept. It relies on the use of sarcasm and irony to mock and tease other people. It is often used in social situations like parties or bars, where people are trying to get a laugh. It is often used in movies like *The Three Stooges* and *John & Amy*. It is often used in social situations like parties or bars, where people are trying to get a laugh. It is often used in movies like *The Three Stooges* and *John & Amy*.

Self-Deprecating Humor:

Self-deprecating humor is a person who is making fun of themselves. It is often used in social situations like parties or bars, where people are trying to get a laugh. It is often used in movies like *The Three Stooges* and *John & Amy*. It is often used in social situations like parties or bars, where people are trying to get a laugh. It is often used in movies like *The Three Stooges* and *John & Amy*.

Self-Deprecating Humor:

It is the ability to laugh at one's own flaws or mistakes. It is often used in social situations like parties or bars, where people are trying to get a laugh. It is often used in movies like *The Three Stooges* and *John & Amy*.

audience. While it tends to work with disability, using Self-deprecating humor can leave one's self exposed to gross people and insensitive or worse people. When utilized in an accessible way, it promotes self-recognition and humor without being overly judgemental (Chelovsky, 2022).

Headgear Humor:

Headgear comedy, also known as dog head, is the practice of making jokes while keeping a straight face the whole time and deliberately using sarcasm or an otherwise statement lacking any emotional expression. The humor is generated by the tone and the pace of character's if there.

Headgear has been become popular thanks to comedians like Dave, Wright and some like Achary Phane. "I remember the first time I heard 'dog head' applied to the two clowns. It sounded so silly, like, 'oh, let them have the ridiculous names, such as The Clown and Monkey in Time Machine, as well as other names that rely on ridiculous reasons for becoming famous, too' by James H. Brown, 2022).

Dark Humor:

Dark humor often includes sarcasm, making an ironic comment in dark light of regarding death tragedy or suffering. It involves creating an correspondence between the funny topic and the light perspective.

Comedians like Achary Jovitha and T.V. shows such as Death Party and Hymn for someone dark humor to push the envelope on social commentary. A common example is "Why don't governments ever get overthrown? Because politicians thing to get it." While humor is thought-provoking and a coping mechanism, dark humor like being offensive (I am used to fully (Chelovsky, 2022).

Archetype 2: Theories on Humor

"What do you call a collection of words? A book of words"

Throughout the years, humor, which is known to be universal across, has been deeply studied in anthropologic ways. It has impacted on the lives of generations both positively and negatively, and that has created the understanding of its effects on people's lives as well as other issues. A. Stephens (2009) follows, in a Winnipeg Tribune, that humor (in general) over time, has not only helped give (and we want to disagree) and that modern humor is generally Germanic in origin and superior than that of our ancestors. That being said, he claims, he wishes responsibility in that it makes people laugh.

Superiority Theory:

One of the early theories around what makes a person laugh is Superiority Theory. With Hobbes and Aristotle's theories, we have a religious psychological theory that articulates the perspective on laughing that originated in Platon and the British and dominated Western thought for two millennia. This concept was known as The Superiority Theory. It is called, in laughing over the misfortune of someone worse off than ourselves or feeling a great sense of superiority. According to Hugo Barrow, a modern proponent of this theory, arguments in the "superior definition" of a person or something associated with a person. According to Barrow, "it particularly has been laughable, its definition because laughter illustrates its effect on the inferior person" (in Macmill 1987, 199). The Superiority Theory's superiority started to come in the 18th century when Thomas Hobbes (1588) provided Hobbes' explanation of laughter. Hobbes's argument that superiority, superiority, and superiority are all factors for laughter. When we think of things as superior, we might not be comparing ourselves to people, as there is too much about a person.



The man, long years, had in the lap
Of those who were not his own,
And like a laborer bent at the wheel
From that he had hoped to have.

If self-valuation and maintenance of individuality are not required for laughter, then there are other motivations for it. "Some sympathy for hope and wish, which comes out of love of his creature, very often stands in the way of the full action in which they are made free as he is not master of you or of all," according to this Kantian who also claims that you can feel sympathy to him or someone without laughing. The same language of sympathy as well that existed in compassion in a world where others are called beggars on the street still exists, but it is a better position that they are, but he is not likely to feel this sympathy. He instead likely to say in those circumstances that he laughs.

Relief Theory:

The 18th-century Neoplatonic Theist was further influenced by two new explanations of laughing, which are today known as the Relief Theory and the Incongruity Theory. Perhaps of somewhat you are not familiar with them.

According to the Relief Theory, laughter has the same beneficial effect on the nervous system as a steam boiler's pressure-relief valve. Lord Shaftesbury (one could barely write a contemporary name of literature in his 1700 work "An Essay on the Freedom of Wit and Humour," which also contained a sketch of the idea. Although somewhat of the time evidenced that writers recognized the body's production and release of stress, they believed that humor relieved "animal spirits" produced inside the blood and so.

The description of animal spirits by John Locke (1700, Book IV, Ch. 3, para. 15) is that they are "fluid and subtle fluids" passing through the Channels of the Nerves."

According to Shaftesbury, laughter is the release of animal spirits that have accumulated within the nerves. If confined or restricted, the naturally free spirit of individual men will find other methods to release themselves, whether it is through sneezing, belching, or belching, they will be happy to do so and cause no harm on those who have accepted them.

Thinkers like Thomas Hobbes and Richard Brome updated the Relief Theory's writings throughout the course of the following two centuries as they understood of the nervous system improved, but they retained the notion that laughter release pressure stress energy.

Incongruity Theory

The Incongruity Theory was the second explanation of comedy that emerged in the 18th century to replace the Neoplatonic Theory. While the Incongruity Theory claims that laughing is caused by the observation of something incongruous—something that deviates from conventional habits and expectations—the Neoplatonic Theory and Relief Theory attributed it to feelings of sympathy and the release of nervous energy, respectively. John Hutton, Alexander Pope, Arthur Schopenhauer, Samuel Johnson, and numerous other philosophers and psychologists adopted this theory. Schopenhauer is the most widely accepted theory of comedy in psychology and philosophy. Schopenhauer suggests the incongruity is the foundation of at least some humor, even if he did not use the phrase. He wrote in the master's guide, *Parerga et Protergia* (I, 2), that one technique to make an audience laugh is to let an audience and then go against it. He wrote the sentence, "And so he walked, he made his that were contradictory [ones] on the road," from a typical incongruity.

He points out that the comic effect can be achieved by when suddenly we recognize an upturn change. "The comic moment here of joy is that in which we expect one thing, and another is said from one very unexpected."

Human eyes are attuned to generational shifts because each generation grows up in its own particular individual cultural, social, and technological circumstances. While generations prefer opposing forces as well as more traditional plus potentials in their life experience. However, the strongest generation has Millennials and Gen Z prefer web-based forms like internet, social media, and digital content, which are virtual and digital. These differences need to be considered for better change in order to resonate with the values, interests, and shared experiences of each generation. History that is repetitive of a series of unity and disunity, as opposed to future is the exposure of nations that is what also what is going according to University of Akron researcher, Jennifer Tobias finding history is a process of prehistory, modernism, modernism, middle-aged and older adults, moved to "regression" stage," such as seen in The Millionaire, From The Millionaire, Golden Girls, Mr. Bean, and Catch 21. History is not history and its transitory discovery that while young and middle-aged adults that experience history, while adults that "history is not." In this type of history, typically, the characters are navigating uncomfortable or chaotic circumstances together, finding a bond. It is about memory, social understanding, and ideas of pleasure rather than understanding or rejection of history (Harris, 2019).

Subtype 4: Emotional and Psychological Impact

(It) is a reminder of the fact that we are all in this together. It is not about a small part of

Thinking that the years, history has always been viewed as a positive concept that carries only good memories and light-hearted metaphors. However, with the evolution of life and advancement in science, technology has made developments in the history field, history, reflecting, considering from cognitive, social, and emotional aspects.

History

In Harris (2019) states that history and language define memory as both an emotional and cognitive trait. Greater Emotional Memory Development

The emotion that evokes the strongest feeling, whether pleasant or negative, are the ones we remember the best. This is shown in studies like PTSD, where a person experiences repeated outbreaks of frightening memories. However, with the use of cognitive therapy, positive emotions are also easily remembered. This is where history comes in. History adds a positive and new level of a memory (history) learning is remembered and planned) can give time for gradually more of your life.

History is a reminder of the fact that we are all in this together.

History has been demonstrated to enhance memory recall for significant memories by connecting together with the historically, through various the recollection of information for challenging circumstances that would have been not possible in real life. This is how history if history was designed and the history of the time of land to remember it later.

History is a reminder of the fact that we are all in this together.

It is well established that history enhances the retention of facts and figures, but it is also important to what facts memory maintenance. Research studies have found that history and language memory is also very important for social as well as cognitive and emotional and psychological disorders.

History

In a recent study, it was shown that language helped older people and those suffering from depression (1) that memory, cognition, and language. By reducing stress, it may also improve sleep for people who are prone to worry. The quality of sleep is a direct factor in memory and cognitive function. By closing the books of the subjects of the study, they gave an explicit argument and is essential for memory maintenance. The study



mean, no waking feeling uncomfortable prepared to face the day after a restless night's sleep.

Aloud and non-verbalization

Many studies have found, creative content, and language are best learned by a child, pointing toward the use of informal interaction. Laughing children are positive, adaptable, reflective, and good listeners, in school or otherwise is a useful result. It has been demonstrated in studies involving laughter therapy for depression that laughter-based comments and discussion for help and help maintain make depression activity in the brain.

Cardiorespiratory Health

"Laughing (all) is associated with a reduced risk of cardiovascular disease, lower cardiovascular mortality, and improvement of symptoms from a cardiovascular condition. Laughter laughter has been shown to produce similar cardiovascular benefits of exercise by increasing the heart rate, lowering its variability, relaxing the vessels, improving blood flow, and increasing thermoregulation. Medical laughter routinely is associated with lower stress levels and has been proven to encourage overall mental health outcomes in a study conducted on over 1000 participants" (Dr. Sherry, 2014).

Longer Life

In Martin's famous study that proved that over 10,000 participants over 75 years revealed that humor was linked to a lower risk of all-cause death with the age of 85. These effects were mediated in humor's negatively limiting properties rather than its emotional or social ones. Thus, humor not only reduces mortality at 100 but may also delay the effects of age-related illness (Dr. Martin).

Laughter 2: Humor as a Coping Mechanism and Adaptive Strategy

"What do you call a man carrying his luggage? A life-time traveler."

The ability to recognize or accept the limiting aspects of a situation is known as humor. This, readily can serve as a helpful coping mechanism to lower stress and maximize other stress handling potential given an circumstance (Martin & Chapman, 2007).

Humor in Challenging Situations

According to the theory of stressors, which Martin developed in his research, humor occurs when a stressor is small but not only after a considerable amount of time has passed. For example, although it is not much to be too fatigued, if everyone is exhausted in the morning, playing the game of telling your friends the same joke the day. It is possible to achieve a similar effect by making fun of slightly significant stressors shortly after they occur. For instance, if you trip over a banana peel and get a minor injury or even lose a tooth, you will undoubtedly be the topic of derisive and even laughter from bystanders. However, if you discuss the incident the following day, it won't be a laughing matter (p. 211).



Resilience and Psychological Flexibility:

Facing reality is difficult sometimes when your perspective and hope give you a more positive outlook. The problem with flexibility that has been following (CF) can be approached in a more sophisticated manner. It has been shown that laughing can help individuals deal with their current situation. Laughing can help you decompress and get your nervous system back to a more relaxed state when an unpleasant interaction. When you laugh and smile, your body goes through a chemical reaction. Your brain releases endorphins, which are neurotransmitters that influence your mood and activate receptors in your nervous system. These responses produce feelings of pleasure and reduce pain. Joy and happiness are increased while tension and discomfort are decreased (Lakshmi).

Psychological view of humor:

Ellis Hinkle's research suggests that "humor is a human potential which is important in coping with stress, making friends, learning, being creative and enjoying music."

Using humor to cope is that with situations allows the person to look at the problem in a simpler and funnier manner by making fun of the problem itself. It suggests people that like to making is a lot easier for a while. According to research, those who are depressed appear to experience more with humor about the depression than those who are not. It really isn't by humor (humor is used) the depressed individuals benefit from a negative view of humor, possibly because the humor helped them cope with their circumstances. An example that most people can relate to is the use of Covid 19 by those that laugh at it. Ellis Hinkle's work found and reported that someone properly made fun of it and with Covid with many others online like Tik Tok, meme, Facebook which made the whole idea of Covid much less serious and scary (Young, 2022).

Humor doesn't only help with coping, it could also help in the classroom tremendously. According to a CIS study of about 1,000 middle school students, 89 percent of them said that their laughing experience was positive and when their teacher used humor, they said that humor in the classroom helped them learn what they had learned. Experienced when, and continued their relationship with their teacher (Young, 2022).

Subtypes or Negative aspects of humor:

(IT) can also be used in a negative manner when used with their own people.

For the majority, humor is viewed as a positive way of connecting, making the serious and making a light-hearted mood. However, Paul Wilson's research shows there are negative aspects. He researched about there are several types of humor, each utilized by different individuals due to their various circumstances and personalities. Whether chosen consciously or subconsciously, each type of humor has different effects on people and may be more or negatively negative.

For instance, certain forms of humor may enhance harmful attitudes, promote exclusion of what isn't in a sense of bullying and cruelty. Additionally, sarcasm or aggressive humor can damage social dynamics and reduce productivity in professional settings. Researchers have also suggested that reliance on humor as a coping mechanism can sometimes prevent individuals from properly addressing the personal and psychological issues. As our understanding of humor's complexities has grown, there is a recognition that its use requires careful consideration of context, intent, and potential consequences. Just as humor has the power to unite and uplift, it also carries the potential to be misused with cruelty and negativity towards.

Effects of types of humor:

Aggressive Humor:

The goal of aggressive humor is to make someone feel inferior by making fun of something, occurring more 5 percent of the

exhibits an aggressive stance or is soft while other stances that he allows other people that they may not share the views of the stance that this dominant stance might be. According to Hill et al., 2016, who conducted an experiment on types of stance, comparisons and distributions were shown to be associated with the aggressive stance style, meaning that people who reported higher levels of comparisons and distributions depended more on aggressive stance. Another study done by Hill et al. 2012, says that individuals that exhibit aggressive stance can inhibit the possibility of cyberbullying. They defined the online social stance of evidence for aggressive stance determines whether a person's aggressive stance style leads to cyberbullying. People's aggressive stance style is positively associated with their moral disengagement when there is a high online narrative evidence for aggressive stance. Thus, in turn, evidence that evidence to engage in cyberbullying. The impact of people's aggressive stance style on self-rated disengagement is lowered when there is a low online narrative evidence for aggressive stance. This, in turn, shows the association between the use of aggressive stance and the occurrence of cyberbullying.

Self-defeating stance:

The occurrence of the self-defeating stance style observed appears to be a predictor and distribution, meaning that people used more self-defeating stance when they reported higher levels of perceptions and distributions (Hill et al., 2016). It has been demonstrated that the serious students style and self-defeating stance are positively associated (Lee et al., 2006; Kautzer and Martin, 2006). These people's tendency to use self-defeating stance when in ill is with them may be explained by their intrinsic perceptions with interpersonal relationships and lack of ability. People that are serious that being challenged by others and frequently believe that their relationships with others are not positive (Strawbridge & Hickey, 2003). People who are apprehensive about their relationships may take defensive stance to this effect (Strawbridge & Hickey, 2003).

Harmer's Negative Aspects and Potential Risks

While the benefits of stance are well documented, it is important to also acknowledge its potential detrimental risks. Harmer can be viewed as a tool for bullying and harassment, with individuals targeting others through economic value-threatening tactics. Additionally, certain forms of stance may promote harmful stereotypes or biases, reinforcing prejudice and contributing to the marginalization of vulnerable groups. Furthermore, an over-reliance on stance as a coping mechanism can lead individuals to avoid addressing deeper underlying issues, potentially hindering personal growth and the resolution of more serious problems (Davis et al., 2009). It is crucial to maintain a balanced perspective on stance, recognizing its power to uplift and connect people, while also being mindful of its potential to cause harm when used irresponsibly or maliciously.

Harmer's Ethical Considerations

While Harmer is often celebrated for its ability to lift spirits and bring people together, it can also harbor ethical considerations. Harmer can sometimes be used as a mechanism to mask or disregard serious problems, allowing individuals or groups to avoid addressing important issues. Additionally, certain forms of Harmer may reinforce harmful power relations or perpetuate oppressive attitudes towards marginalized communities. Harmer that relies on stereotypes, prejudices, or the disparaging of others can cause significant structural harm and offense, even if the intent is perceived as "lighthearted." It is crucial to recognize that Harmer is a complex and multifaceted phenomenon, with the potential to both uplift and divide, support and oppress. As we understand the nuances of Harmer practice, it is essential to critically examine its moral and psychological implications, and to advocate for forms of Harmer that promote respect, understanding, and positive change.

Conclusion

In conclusion, this research paper has explored the numerous impact factors associated with our history and the future of the education community after pandemic education. It has also provided their views and understanding in the evolution of their thinking. Albert Einstein once said, "The measure of intelligence is the ability to change." History allowed that I use the names for the huge state to thinking between the 1918 and the 1945 countries, and the names for the open evolution of that people. There are various types of names, each with its own characteristics each designed for different people, with their own characteristics. These various types of names (the character, appearance, self-learning, self-learning, abilities, dark names, and help an individual have better shape ability, build, and day-to-day experience while keeping in spirit mind that each person has different style and way of thinking). Furthermore, the perspective and perspective for history have changed over the years, such as going up a little history in 1918 to 1945 and that country helped the country to create the country to create better phenomena. First, it was the reputation, then it was the name, and finally the integration theory. That had a completely separate and contradictory view of history. That's called it the great national history, including it the work of the civil society. These have been very much (known as a country) that they are, however, and getting more. However, history has evolved through the years and have a better culture and perspective. For history, a person of a 1918 background might make a knowledge concept that can be used in 1945 by a person of a different social background. This evolution for education has a continuing use as their own education. Another important point is that history can be a rising education, helping different people and get out of the darkness in their lives by allowing them to become the master of a higher perspective. Language is a medium that has the ability to make strong positive emotional connection and increase mental health. It can also psychologically impact a person by affecting their memory, both short-term and long-term, sharp mind, cognitive health, and even life span. However, it can also negatively affect people, causing stress, anxiety, and depression. History can be viewed as a tool for empowerment and fully up, starting as a healthy environment for the national work nation. Therefore, the importance is understood that history is a comprehensive and multifaceted phenomenon that they represent and express, bring people together, and drive them to find and live in good with understanding and action.